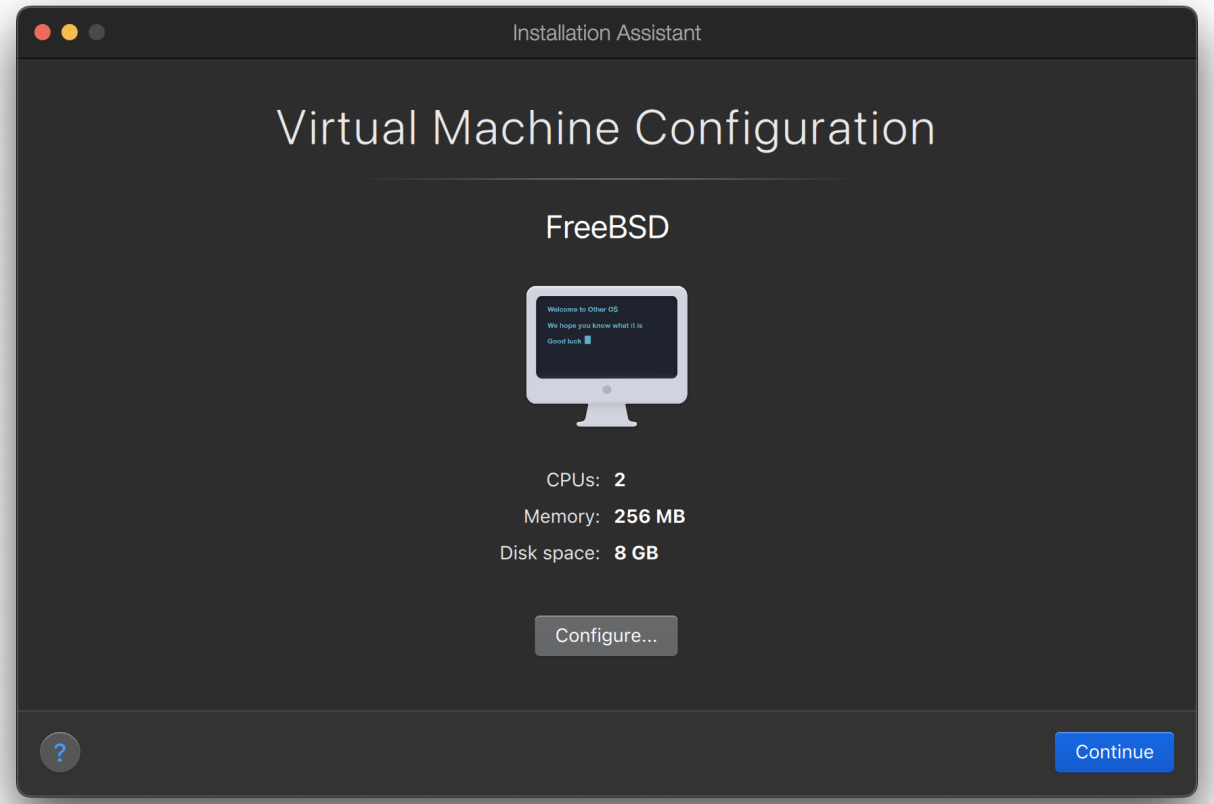


The virtual machine will automatically boot. Install FreeBSD following the general steps.



24.2.2. Configuring FreeBSD on Parallels

After FreeBSD has been successfully installed on macOS® X with Parallels, there are a number of configuration steps that can be taken to optimize the system for virtualized operation.

1. Set Boot Loader Variables

   The most important step is to reduce the `kern.hz` tunable to reduce the CPU utilization of FreeBSD under the Parallels environment. This is accomplished by adding the following line to /boot/loader.conf:

   ```
   kern.hz=100
   ```

   Without this setting, an idle FreeBSD Parallels guest will use roughly 15% of the CPU of a single processor iMac®. After this change the usage will be closer to 5%.

   If installing FreeBSD 14.0 or later, and CPU utilization is still high, add the following additional line to /boot/loader.conf:

   ```
   debug.acpi.disabled="ged"
   ```

2. Create a New Kernel Configuration File

   All SCSI, FireWire, and USB device drivers can be removed from a custom kernel configuration file. Parallels provides a virtual network adapter used by the ed(4) driver, so all network devices except for ed(4) and miibus(4) can be removed from the kernel.

3. Configure Networking

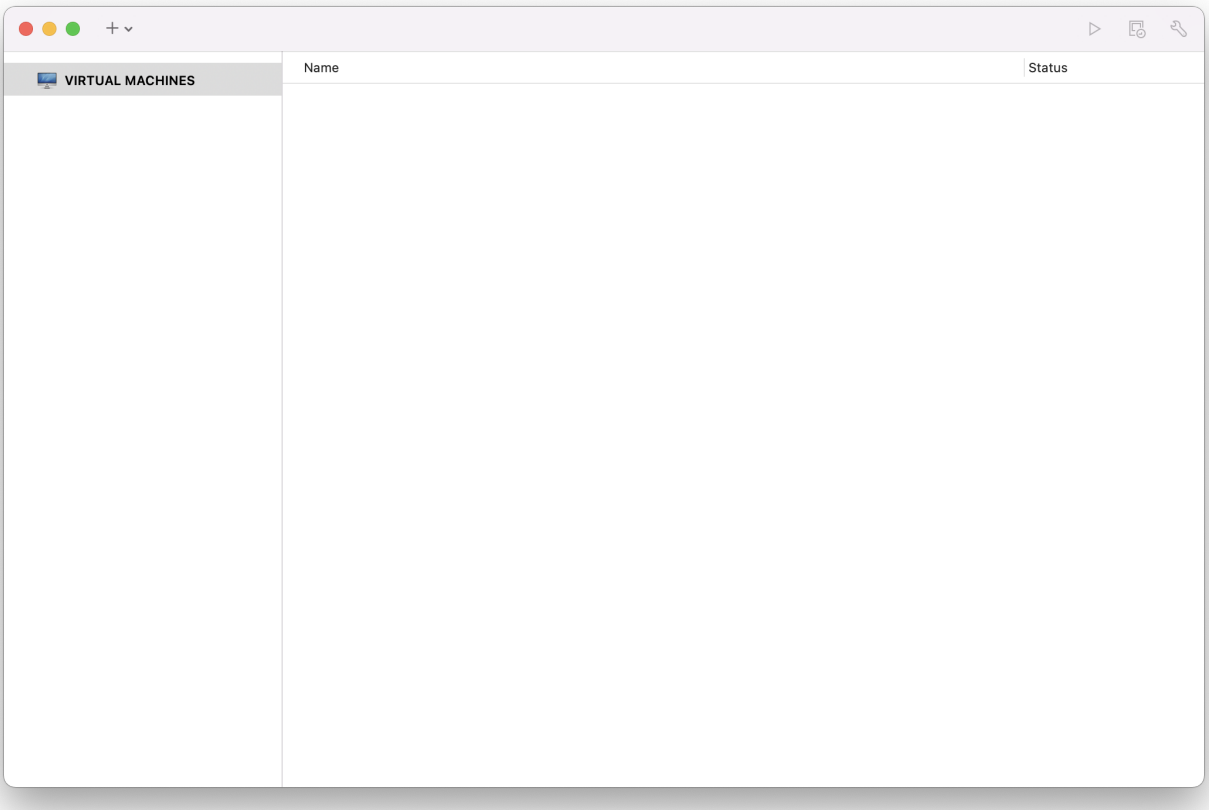
   The most basic networking setup uses DHCP to connect the virtual machine to the same local area network as the host Mac®. This can be accomplished by adding `ifconfig_ed0="DHCP"` to /etc/rc.conf. More advanced networking setups are described in Advanced Networking.

24.3. FreeBSD as a Guest on VMware Fusion for macOS®

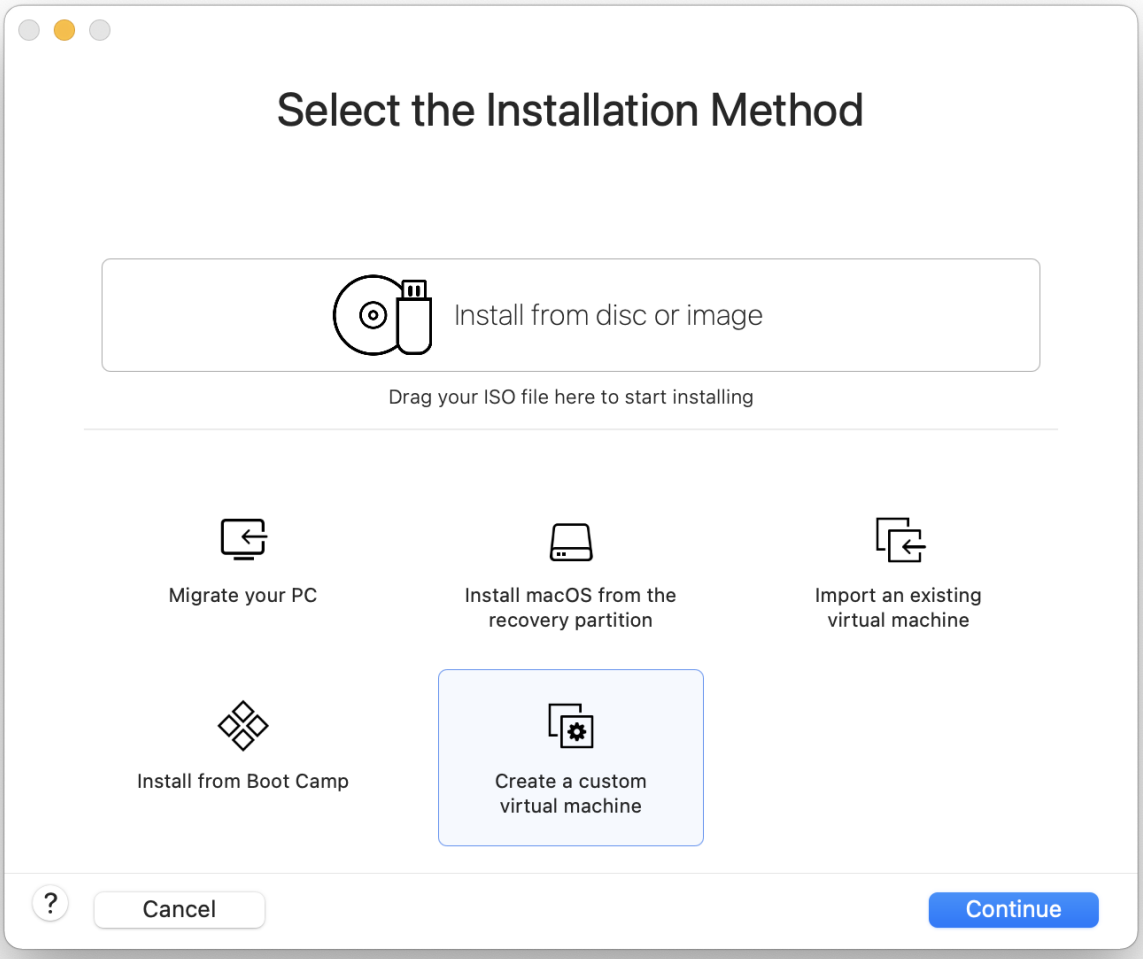
VMware Fusion for Mac® is a commercial software product available for Apple® Mac® computers running macOS® 12 or higher. FreeBSD is a fully supported guest operating system. Once VMware Fusion has been installed on macOS®, the user can configure a virtual machine and then install the desired guest operating system.

24.3.1. Installing FreeBSD on VMware Fusion

The first step is to start VMware Fusion which will load the Virtual Machine Library. Click +→New to create the virtual machine:



This will load the New Virtual Machine Assistant. Choose Create a custom virtual machine and click Continue to proceed:



Select Other as the Operating System and either FreeBSD X or FreeBSD X 64-bit, as the **Version** when prompted: